Apex Innovations Employee Operations & Policy Handbook

Version: 2024.3 | **Effective Date:** January 1, 2024 | **Human Resources Department**

1. Workplace Arrangements & Working Hours

Apex Innovations operates under a flexible hybrid working framework. Standard office core collaboration hours are from **10:00 AM to 4:00 PM Eastern Standard Time (EST)**, Monday through Friday. All full-time employees are expected to be reachable and active during these hours.

2. Hybrid Work Policy & Office Attendance

Employees assigned to hybrid status are required to work a minimum of **2 days per week on-site** at their designated regional office, with the remaining 3 days permitted as remote work from home. Remote work outside the country of employment is permitted for up to a maximum of **30 consecutive calendar days per year**, subject to prior written authorization from HR and IT compliance.

3. Paid Time Off (PTO) & Leave Allocations

Full-time permanent employees accrue **25 business days of paid annual vacation** per calendar year, accrued on a semi-monthly basis. In addition, employees receive **10 days of paid medical/sick leave** annually, which does not require medical practitioner verification for absences of 2 days or fewer.

4. Parental Leave Entitlements

New parents, whether through birth, adoption, or surrogacy, are entitled to **16 weeks of fully paid parental leave** for the primary caregiver, and **8 weeks of fully paid leave** for the secondary caregiver. This leave must be taken within the first 12 months following the qualifying event.

5. PTO Request Protocol

Any scheduled PTO request exceeding 3 consecutive working days must be submitted through the internal HR portal at least **14 calendar days in advance**. A maximum of 5 unused vacation days may be rolled over into the subsequent calendar year, expiring on March 31.

6. Expense Reimbursement Guidelines

Business-related expenses incurred on behalf of the company must be submitted via the Concur expense portal within **30 calendar days of purchase**. Itemized receipts are strictly mandatory for all expenditures exceeding **$25.00 USD**. Daily meal allowances during approved travel are capped at **$75.00 USD per diem**.

7. Home Office & Equipment Stipend

To support ergonomic and productive remote working conditions, new full-time hires are provided a one-time home office equipment stipend of **$1,200.00 USD**, usable for monitors, ergonomic chairs, desks, and peripheral devices. In addition, an ongoing monthly remote connectivity subsidy of **$60.00 USD** is credited on monthly payroll.

8. Information Security & Hardware Guidelines

Company-issued laptops are encrypted and monitored. Connecting personal USB flash drives or unapproved external mass storage devices to company hardware is strictly prohibited. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) via authenticator app or hardware token is mandatory across all enterprise cloud services.